



Presented by The High End



CARDBOARD RACE CAR COCKPIT

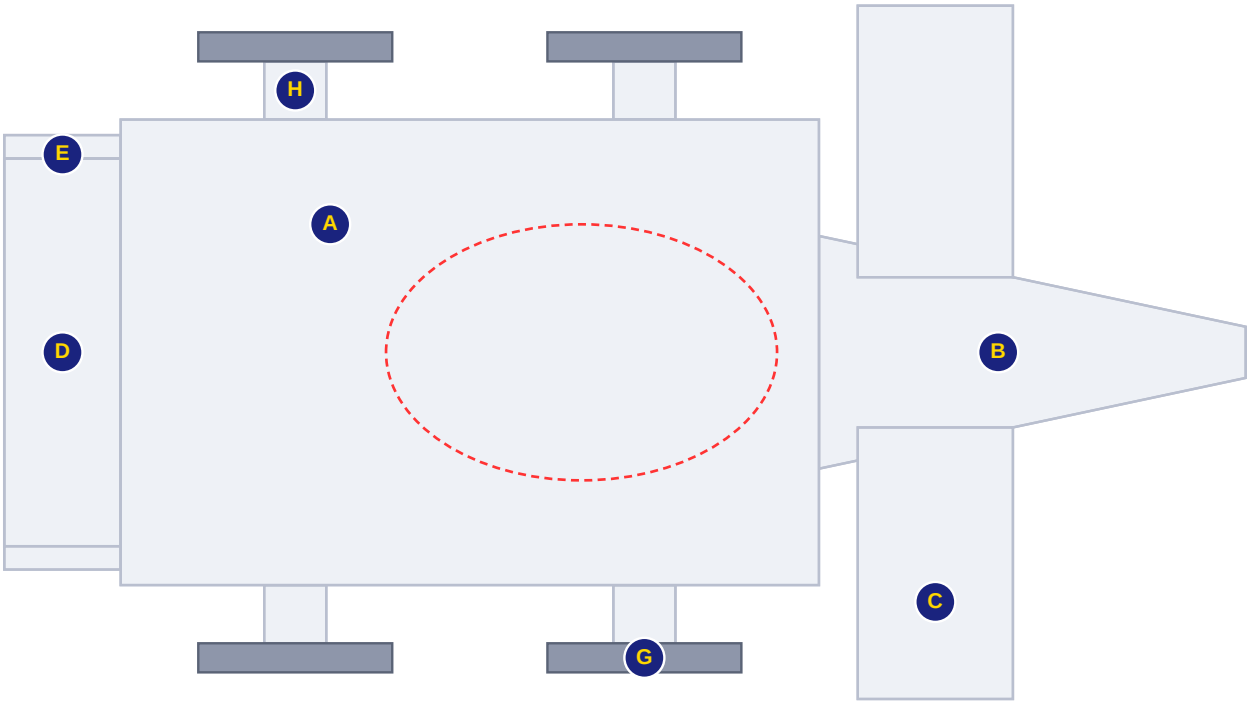
Life-Size Sit-In Formula Racing Car

Build a Formula 1 cockpit. Race from the bedroom. Trophies not included.

AGES 4–12	BOXES 3–4 Large Boxes	TIME 2–2.5 Hours	DIFF Beginner *	PIECES 8 pcs
CARDBOARD NEEDED: 3–4 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)				
MISSION GOAL: Build a low, wide F1 cockpit: extended nose cone, front + rear wings, four road wheels, steering wheel. Child sits low inside.				

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD RACE CAR COCKPIT

Seen from directly above. Every part you cut is on this picture, with the letter from its own cut-template page. If a letter is on this drawing, there is a page for it in this file — that is the whole parts list, nothing else is needed.



Drawn to scale from the cut sizes in this plan. Front of the car is to the right.

EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD					
A	CAR BODY (FULL BOX) 36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm)	CUT ×1	B	NOSE CONE 12" × 22" (30 × 56 cm)	CUT ×1
C	FRONT WING ELEMENT 14" × 8" (36 × 20 cm)	CUT ×2	D	REAR WING ELEMENT 20" × 6" (51 × 15 cm)	CUT ×1
E	REAR WING ENDPLATE 6" × 8" (15 × 20 cm)	CUT ×2	F	STEERING WHEEL (CIRCLE) 8" × 8" (20 × 20 cm)	CUT ×2
G	ROAD WHEEL (DISC) 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)	CUT ×8	H	WHEEL SPACER (ROLL) 12" × 3" (30 × 8 cm)	CUT ×4

WHEEL MOUNT — LOOKING DOWN ON ONE WHEEL

CAR BODY SIDE

H SPACER TUBE
3"

G 2 DISCS 10" taped face to face = 1 wheel

FROM THE SIDE — WHERE THE AXLE MARKS GO

body height = however deep your box is

Four marks in all — 9" in from each end, 2" up from the bottom edge, on BOTH sides. The wheel hangs below the body; that is what gives it ground clearance.

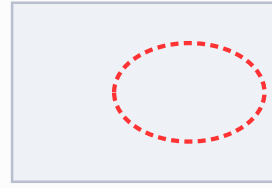
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the car once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and your car should look like each picture in turn.

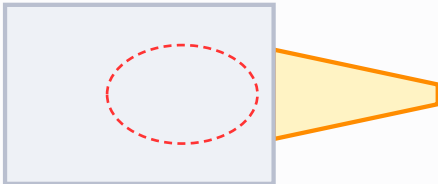
1 ORIENT THE CAR BODY



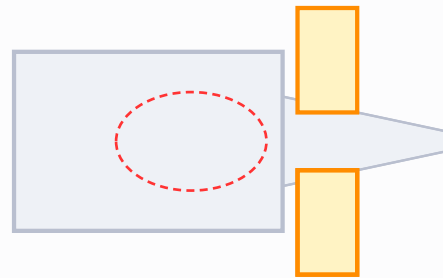
2 CUT THE COCKPIT



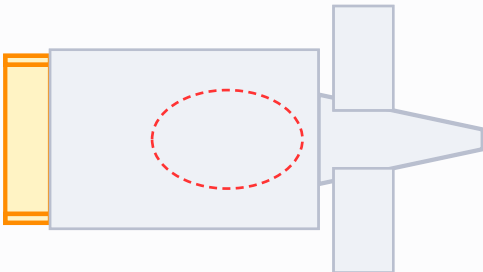
3 ATTACH THE NOSE CONE



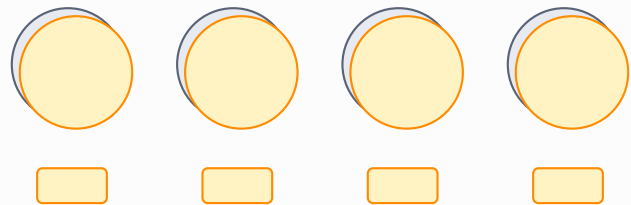
4 ADD FRONT WINGS



5 BUILD THE REAR WING

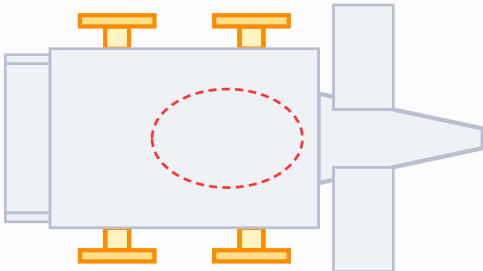


6 CUT THE ROAD WHEELS

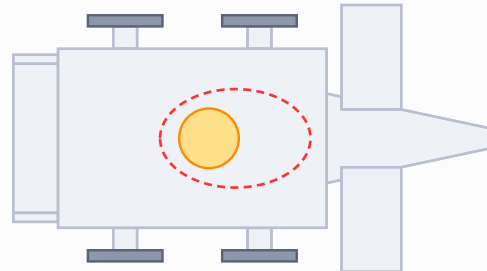


4 WHEELS (2 DISCS EACH) + 4 TUBES

7 MOUNT THE ROAD WHEELS



8 ADD STEERING WHEEL



FINISHED CAR CHECK

Nose cone out front. A front wing each side, wider than the body. Rear wing up on its two endplates. 4 road wheels, 2 a side, standing 3" clear of the body. Steering wheel inside the cockpit. That is every part in the table above, all used.



CAR BODY (FULL BOX)

36" x 24" (91 x 61 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

CAR BODY (FULL BOX)

x1

0" 4" 8" 12" 16" 20" 24" 28" 32"

4" 3" 12" 13" 20"

CUT COCKPIT OVAL on top: child sits low, shoulders at edge. Adult only.

36" x 24" (91 x 61 cm)
Flip on its side — long = car length

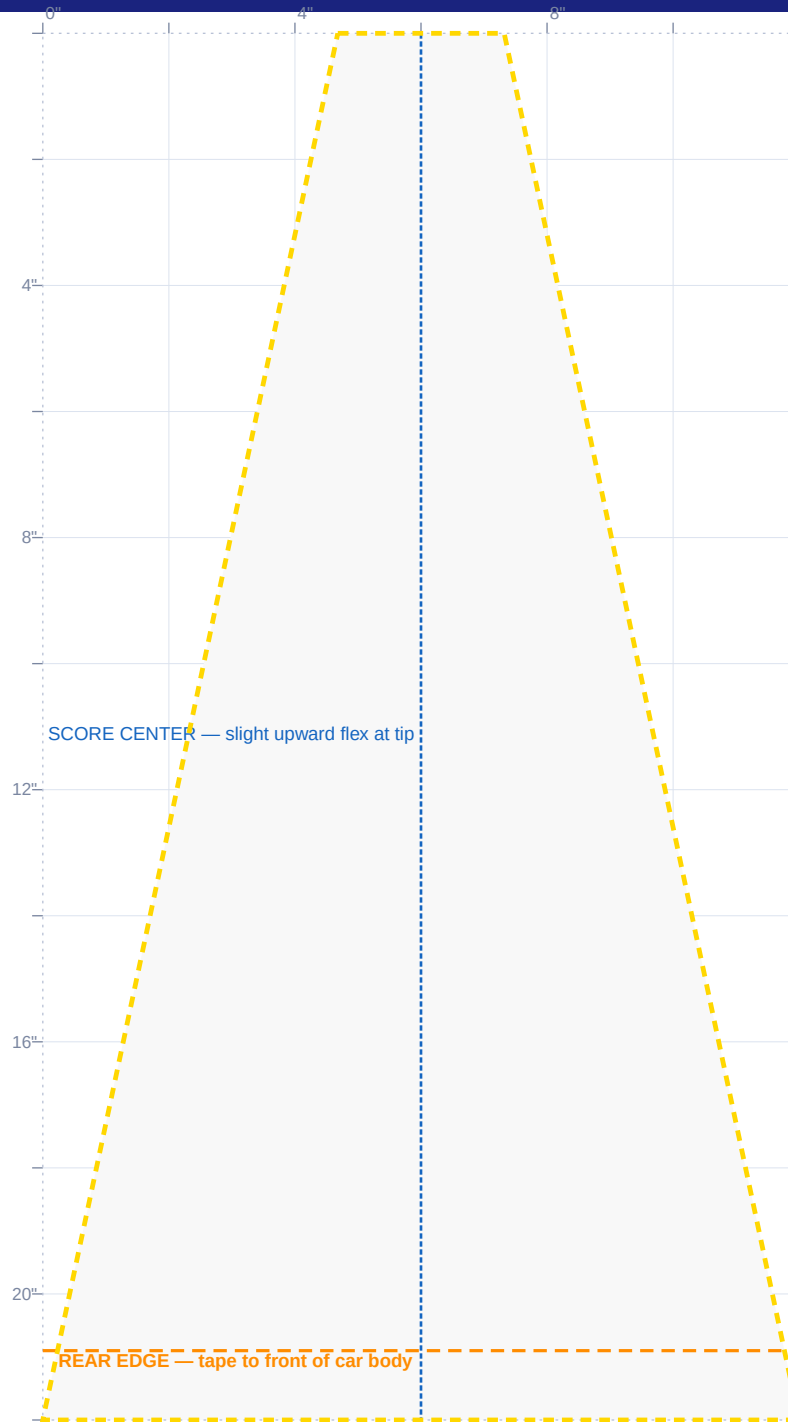
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

OVAL — cut oval shape: pin string at center, trace with pencil

NOTE: Flip on its side — long = car length

NOSE CONE

x1

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

Mark 4.7" in from each TOP corner — that leaves a 2.6" nose. Draw straight lines from those marks down to the bottom corners.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

12" × 22" (30 × 56 cm)

F1 nose — wide at the back, narrow at the point

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Long taper to a point



FRONT WING ELEMENT

14" x 8" (36 x 20 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2

FRONT WING ELEMENT

x2

0"

4"

8"

12"

4"

INNER EDGE — tape to nose cone sides, angled slightly down

14" x 8" (36 x 20 cm)
Wide flat — attach low at nose

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Wide flat — attach low at nose



REAR WING ELEMENT

20" × 6" (51 × 15 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

REAR WING ELEMENT

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

4"

20" × 6" (51 × 15 cm)
Horizontal wing at rear

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Horizontal wing at rear



REAR WING ENDPLATE

6" × 8" (15 × 20 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

REAR WING ENDPLATE

0"

4"

4"

6" × 8" (15 × 20 cm)

Vertical plates — hold rear wing

BASE TAB — tape to rear of car body

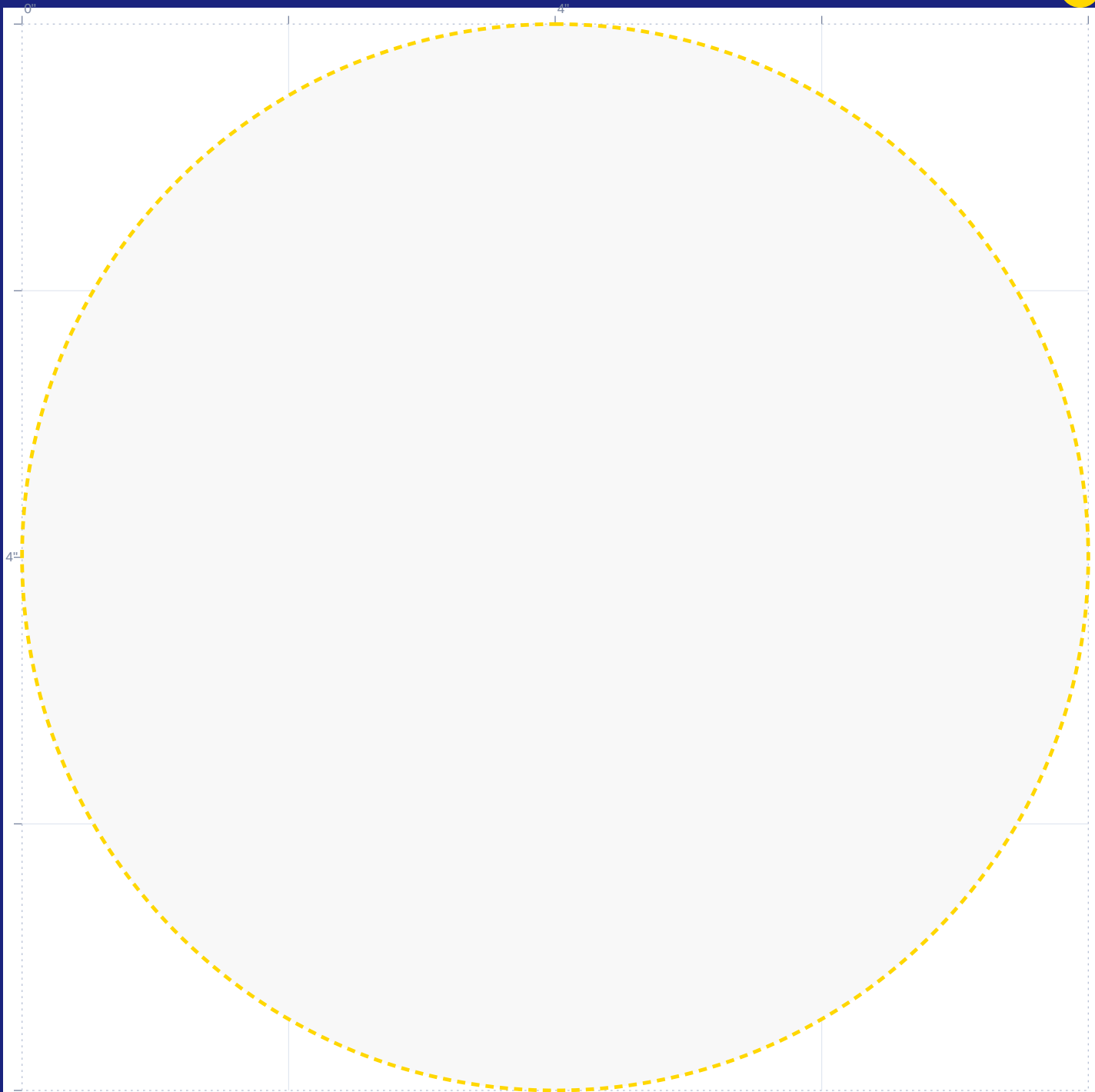
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Vertical plates — hold rear wing

STEERING WHEEL (CIRCLE)

x2

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

A circle 8" across. Trace a dinner plate, or pin a string 4" from the centre and swing a pencil right round.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

8" × 8" (20 × 20 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Stack for thickness



ROAD WHEEL (DISC)

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm) | Cut ×8

CUT
x8

ROAD WHEEL (DISC) x8

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

A circle 10" across. Pin a string 5" from the centre and swing a pencil right round, or draw round a dinner plate and widen it to 10". Cut 8 and tape them in pairs — 2 discs make 1 wheel, and you need 4 wheels.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Two discs taped together make one wheel — 4 wheels



WHEEL SPACER (ROLL)

12" x 3" (30 x 8 cm) | Cut x4

CUT
x4

WHEEL SPACER (ROLL)

x4

0"4"8"

ROLL

ROLL the long edge round into a tube 3" long, then tape the seam

12" x 3" (30 x 8 cm)

Rolls into a short tube — holds each wheel clear of the body

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ROLL — roll the cardboard tightly in this direction

NOTE: Rolls into a short tube — holds each wheel clear of the body

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD RACE CAR COCKPIT

CARDBOARD PIECES — 8 TOTAL (3–4 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×1 Car Body (full box)
36" × 24" *Flip on its side — long = car length*

×1 Nose Cone
12" × 22" *Long taper to a point*

×2 Front Wing Element
14" × 8" *Wide flat — attach low at nose*

×1 Rear Wing Element
20" × 6" *Horizontal wing at rear*

×2 Rear Wing Endplate
6" × 8" *Vertical plates — hold rear wing*

×2 Steering Wheel (circle)
8" × 8" *Stack for thickness*

×8 Road Wheel (disc)
10" × 10" *Two discs taped together make one wheel — 4 wheels*

×4 Wheel Spacer (roll)
12" × 3" *Rolls into a short tube — holds each wheel clear of the body*

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 3–4 large cardboard boxes

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape

+ Bold racing colors (red, yellow, or choice)

+ Black paint for the road wheels

+ Black + white markers

+ Ruler

FUN FACT!

Real F1 cars go 0 to 60 in under 2.5 seconds. Yours goes 0 to imagination instantly. Same energy.

CHALLENGE!

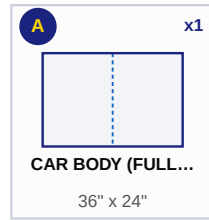
Race day: two kids, two cardboard cars. Decorate differently. Who has the fastest-looking car? Race on 3... 2... 1... GO!

1

STEP 1: ORIENT THE CAR BODY

Take one large sealed box. Flip it on its side so the LONG dimension is now the car length, not the height. This low, wide orientation is the key to looking like an F1 car instead of a box.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

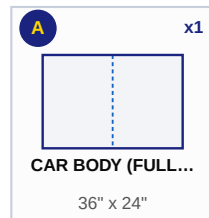
STEP 2: CUT THE COCKPIT

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

On the TOP of the box, cut the cockpit oval (oval mark on template). Child should slide in and sit low — only shoulders and head above the car body. This is the F1 driver position.

SAFETY: Adult cuts the cockpit oval. Test fit with child before finishing edges.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

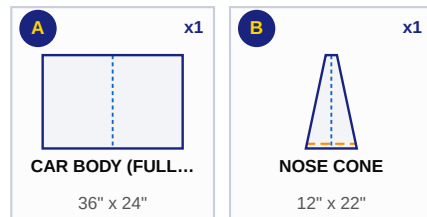


3

STEP 3: ATTACH THE NOSE CONE

Tape the Nose Cone piece to the front of the car body (rear edge fold mark). Score the center vertical line (score mark) and flex the tip slightly upward. Taper cuts on both sides give it the long aggressive F1 nose shape.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

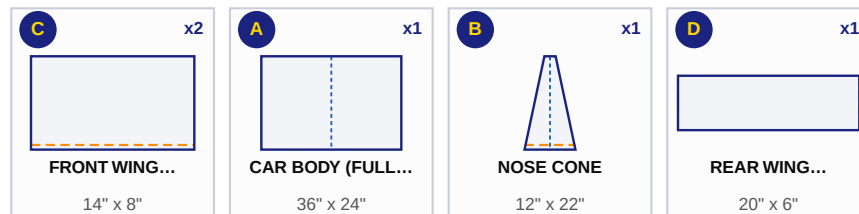


4

STEP 4: ADD FRONT WINGS

Tape a Front Wing Element to each side of the nose cone (inner edge fold mark), angling slightly downward. These should extend WIDER than the car body on each side.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



5

STEP 5: BUILD THE REAR WING

Tape both Rear Wing Endplates upright at the very rear of the car (base tab fold mark). Tape the Rear Wing Element horizontally between the tops of both endplates. This T-shape is the rear wing.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

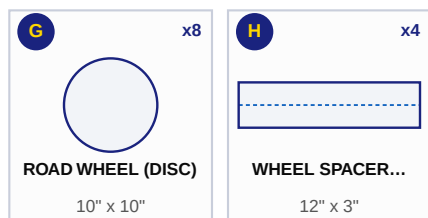
STEP 6: CUT THE ROAD WHEELS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut 8 Road Wheel discs — circles 10" (25 cm) across (circle mark on template). Tape them together in pairs so you finish with 4 thick wheels. Then take each of the 4 Wheel Spacer strips, roll the long edge round into a tube 3" (8 cm) long (roll mark) and tape the seam closed. One wheel spacer per wheel.

SAFETY: Adult cuts the 8 discs. Cardboard circles need a box cutter, not scissors — cut on a board, never on your lap.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



7

STEP 7: MOUNT THE ROAD WHEELS

On each side of the car body mark two axle points: 9" (23 cm) in from the front edge and 9" (23 cm) in from the rear edge, both 2" (5 cm) up from the bottom edge. That is 4 marks in total, 2 per side. Tape one wheel spacer tube flat onto each mark, then tape a road wheel onto the open outer end of each tube. The tube holds the wheel 3" (8 cm) clear of the body so it stands proud like a real tyre instead of lying flat against the side.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

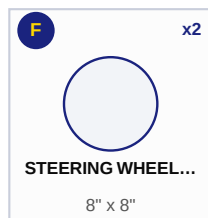


8

STEP 8: ADD STEERING WHEEL

Cut and stack 2 Steering Wheel circles (circle mark). Tape together. Mount inside the cockpit on a short tape column at the right height for a seated child to hold.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

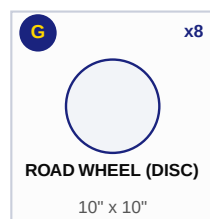


9

STEP 9: PAINT YOUR LIVERY

Choose bold racing colors. Paint the nose one color, the body another. Paint all four road wheels black, then add a light grey or silver circle in the middle of each one for the hub. Add racing stripes, a large number on the nose, a team name on the side. Make it look FAST.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

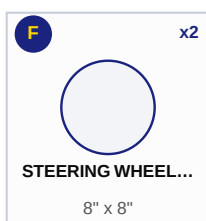
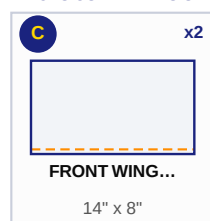


10

STEP 10: QUALITY CHECK

Child sits low in the cockpit. Steering wheel at hand height. Long nose extended. Front wings wide. Rear wing mounted. Four road wheels mounted, two per side, standing clear of the body. Bold racing colors. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations